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Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

Document: NSF_FRDOC_0001-DRAFT-1879

Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

Submitter Information

Email: [REDACTED]

Organization: Jobs for the Future

General Comment

Jobs for the Future (JFF) is pleased to submit a response to the National Science Foundation's Request for Information on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan.

As AI continues to transform the workforce and economy, we appreciate the opportunity to share insights and recommendations on AI-driven policies that can help build a highly skilled workforce, expand economic opportunity for American workers, and enhance the growth and global competitiveness of U.S. businesses.

Please find our response attached for your review. We welcome the opportunity to engage further and look forward to continued collaboration on this critical issue.

Attachments

RFI AI Action Plan_JFF Response

RFI AI Action Plan_JFF Response 3.25

RFI AI Action Plan_JFF



AI Action Plan
Faisal D'Souza, NCO
2415 Eisenhower Avenue
Alexandria VA
22314

RE: OSTP and NITRD NCO AI Action Plan

For over 40 years, JFF has been dedicated to advancing education and workforce system reforms that drive stronger economic outcomes for American learners and workers. To make a bolder commitment to our mission, in 2023 JFF announced a new North Star – stating that 75 million Americans who are currently underemployed or unemployed will be in good jobs by 2030.

We believe artificial intelligence (AI) holds extraordinary potential to help us reach this goal: creating and transforming jobs, revolutionizing our economy, expanding opportunities, and building a world where everyone can build livelihoods and thrive. To realize this vision, workers and learners should have a seat at the table to shape AI's development and use.

JFF's Center for Artificial Intelligence and the Future of Work is committed to ensuring that AI serves as a tool for expanding access to employment and strong economic outcomes. The Center for AI focuses on three key areas:

- **How AI is Reshaping Jobs:** Preparing employers, jobseekers, and the institutions serving them to understand how AI will reshape occupations across sectors and reimagine training pathways, supports, and upskilling strategies, especially for occupations that do not require a bachelor's degree.
- **Emerging AI Use Cases and Solutions for the Future of Work and Learning:** Mapping and supporting rapid validation and adoption of the most promising AI-powered use cases and platforms for the future of work and learning, from foundational AI literacy to personalized coaching and tutoring tools to next-generation assessments to skills-first hiring and talent mobility.
- **Implications for Policy, Practice, and Resources:** Catalyzing sustainable policy, practice, and investment in solutions that drive economic opportunity.

As a result, we are pleased to respond to the OSTP and NITRD NCO Request for Information on the development of a national AI Action Plan.

KEY CONSIDERATIONS FOR THE AI ACTION PLAN

New results from a forthcoming survey commissioned by JFF and conducted by AudienceNet indicate that while interest in and use of AI are growing in learning, at work, and for career advancement, notable challenges remain:

- **AI adoption is accelerating** – 35% of respondents use AI at work (up from 8% in 2023), and 57% report AI integration in education (up from 13% in 2023).
- **AI tools are shaping work experiences** – 36% of respondents report they currently use AI tools at work, noting they make tasks more efficient and productive. Respondents also said AI tools reduce repetitive tasks (29%) and make jobs more interesting and engaging (26%).
- **Access remains a challenge** – Many workers and learners engage with AI independently and of their own volition rather than through employer- or institution-led initiatives. 56% of workers said they don't feel prepared to use AI in their work.
- **AI-driven career shifts are underway** – 19% of respondents said they are actively pursuing different careers or considering changing plans in the near future (12%) due to AI-driven transformation.
- **Entrepreneurship opportunities are emerging** – 8% of respondents use AI tools to start or grow businesses.
- **Top skills in demand** – Problem-solving abilities, adaptability, and creativity and innovation are respondents' most cited skills needed for the AI era.

Additional insights from JFF and the Center for AI point to opportunities and challenges within America's workforce and education systems, including:

- **The need to better understand and prepare workers for AI's potential impact on jobs across the economy.** JFF's [AI-Ready Workforce](#) framework found that AI—especially generative AI—has the potential to augment durable skills such as communication, critical thinking, and relationship-building in ways that make human workers even more effective, without replacing the need for human-to-human interaction. This dynamic makes it more important over time for workers to sharpen these capabilities, and to design future jobs and training programs to capitalize on these durable skills. However, while [training providers we've spoken with](#) recognized the importance of human and professional skills for an AI-transformed future of work, they are finding it challenging to systematically incorporate these skills, with barriers including assessments, time limitations, and scope. The remarkable growth in AI makes shaping technology/human partnerships especially urgent.
- **AI adoption across the education and workforce ecosystem needs to accelerate.** While JFF has found promising [use cases for generative AI in workforce development](#), gaps exist, including for tools to support skill assessment, the development of social capital through networking and peer relationships, and resource navigation. Educational institutions are shouldering some of the biggest AI

challenges of any sector, navigating academic integrity; faculty, staff, and student upskilling; innovations in pedagogy, student supports, and administrative efficiencies; curriculum review and approval processes; reimagining career education and supports for the future of work; and digital transformation and change management, all in a moment of declining enrollments and constrained funding. [Postsecondary training providers we've connected with](#) recognize the importance of internal AI adoption to elevate both organizational efficiency and learner support, but most are just beginning implementation. Finally, [AI-driven assessments](#) and [verifiable credentials wallets](#) can help individuals document and credential skills gained through community programs or workplace experiences, making these learning pathways more visible and valuable in the labor market—and [while workers find digital wallets and credentials helpful, their use is not yet widespread.](#)

- **Access to inadequate labor market information:** AI-powered career tools have the potential to level the playing field by making labor market insights more accessible. But both public and real-time labor market data sources are [limited](#) in their timeliness, accuracy, and ability to identify emerging shifts. As a result, few Americans have the information they need to make informed choices about their careers. For example, [only 26% of parents](#) surveyed by JFF think their high schoolers are “very” prepared for their post-high school education and career transition and only [20% of recent graduates](#) of public four-year institutions said they received quality education-to-career coaching. It’s clear not only the data but the tools used to convey this career information to the public need to be enhanced and addressed to inform the public on high-growth opportunities and the skills needed to access those jobs.
- **Significantly expanding AI literacy.** Not only do individuals need a way to demonstrate skills, but they also need to be constantly upskilling to ensure they have basic skills to operate in an AI-infused and technologically advanced economy. While efforts to scale AI literacy training are growing, there’s still [much more to do](#) to ensure those efforts reach everyone. For example, an internal JFF analysis of the five most popular AI literacy tools found that many common curricula are written at a grade 11 reading level—putting them [out of reach for many adult learners](#). And while 77% of workers and jobseekers in JFF’s survey said they believe AI would have an impact on the job or career they expected to have in the next three to five years, only 31% of workers said their employers offered training on general AI fundamentals, or how to use specific AI tools and systems or both.

JFF’S RECOMMENDATIONS

To address these challenges and ensure that AI fuels greater economic prospects for American workers and businesses, JFF recommends the following key actions:

- 1) **Establish an AI Center of Excellence.** The Administration should create a dedicated federal research hub to analyze AI’s workforce impact and identify best

practices for integrating AI and these insights into education, workplaces, and job training. This Center should convene interdisciplinary experts to improve labor market insights and AI policy responses, conduct, coordinate, and amplify research on the unique value of human skills, capabilities, and work as distinct from that of machines, and share best practices and technical assistance with businesses and workforce leaders to help fuel human-driven growth.

- 2) **Launch a Digital Transformation Fund.** This digital transformation fund would incentivize system modernization by encouraging states to adopt AI and related technologically advanced tools to support their state education and workforce infrastructure, such as through pilots, best-practice resources, maturity models, communities of practice, pro bono technical advisement such as through rotational fellowships for early-career AI technologists, and knowledge exchange with trusted vendor communities. This transformation to a more digitally inclined public sector will prioritize AI-infused service delivery across federal and state programs; create AI-powered career navigation tools that are validated and widely accessible and ensure AI tools for hiring and credentialing position all workers and learners for economic mobility.
- 3) **Strengthen Workforce Data.** To do any of this work well, especially career navigation and advisement, the Administration's AI Plan must have a focus on improving real-time labor market data to track AI-driven job trends. The Administration should identify gaps in public workforce datasets and invest in the creation and/or curation of transparent, high-quality, representative data and public data infrastructure that is accessible to all, including [exploring novel approaches](#) and ensuring data integrity and privacy protections. This will mean adequate resources for public data collection while also working more closely with industry to ensure information is employer-informed and responsive to the changing needs of industry.
- 4) **Expand AI Literacy & Skills Training.** It is clear most American workers will need additional upskilling to develop the competencies to succeed in an AI-fueled economy. In response, the Administration must champion AI literacy training, from K-12 into the workforce, positioning workers and learners to be responsible users, managers, and creators of AI. This AI Plan should also prioritize the development of additional future-ready skills that will be essential to capitalize on opportunities afforded by AI, such as the durable skills discussed above, entrepreneurship, and data literacy. It should promote skill development initiatives, including employer incentives for AI training and workforce upskilling, professional development in AI competency training for public sector employees, including educators, and workforce organizations and greater support for entrepreneurs in leveraging AI to build businesses, create jobs, and generate wealth. Lastly, as an immediate step, the Administration should work with Congress to pass the *Digital Skills for Today's Workforce Act* to scale generative AI training. This legislation can be leveraged to support the Administration's AI Plan and create aligning priorities between the Executive and Legislative branches of government.

CONCLUSION

JFF urges the Administration to prioritize AI-driven policies that expand economic opportunity, ensuring that workers, learners, and businesses can thrive in the AI-powered future.

We welcome the opportunity to collaborate on strategies to unlock the full potential of AI for American economic opportunity, growth, and competitiveness. For further discussion, please contact Karishma Merchant, Associate Vice President of Policy and Advocacy, at [REDACTED] and Alex Swartzel, Managing Director of the Insights practice, JFF Labs at [REDACTED]

Thank you for considering our response. We look forward to working together to shape an AI economy that benefits all.

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